

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

AI Literacy • Lesson 2 of 6

THE TRAINING DATA LESSON

What's in the Playlist?

Gap in the playlist, **gap** in the AI.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

Playlist Check



Name: _____ Partner: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

You are the AI. The playlist below is your **training data** — every song you have ever "heard." Work in pairs. **Partner A is the App:** you pick the song. **Partner B is the Request Line:** you read each request out loud, like a caller on a radio show. Swap jobs after request #3. To **serve** a song means to pick a card and hand it over. Three rules:

- **Rule 1:** Only serve cards from the playlist. No inventing songs mid-game.
- **Rule 2:** Never say no. Serve the closest card you've got — a music app always gives you *something*.
- **Rule 3:** Check ONE Fit box (Perfect / Kind of / Nothing) honestly, on your own sheet. Your checks are the data.

THE PLAYLIST — ALL 12 SONGS YOU KNOW

Thunder Mode Hype Trap · Fast · Party	Bass Quake Electro Party · Fast · Party	Level Up Anthem Hype Trap · Fast · Gym	Foot Court Press Stadium Hype · Fast · Sports
Neon Stampede Electro Party · Fast · Party	Turbo Turbo Electro Party · Fast · Gym	Crowd Goes Wild Stadium Hype · Fast · Sports	Volume War Hype Trap · Fast · Party
Midnight Sprint Electro Party · Fast · Gym	Glow Up Tonight Party Pop · Fast · Party	Confetti Cannon Party Pop · Fast · Party	Cool Down (Kinda) Party Pop · Medium · Party

Hype = loud and exciting. Cut the cards apart, or just point. Notice anything about this playlist yet? Keep that idea for later.

SERVE THE REQUEST LINE

Request Line **reads** it. App **serves** the best card. Both of you write the card and check ONE Fit box on your own sheet.

REQUEST	BEST CARD IN YOUR PLAYLIST	PERFECT FIT	KIND OF FITS	NOTHING FITS
1. Nia needs a hype song for when the basketball team runs onto the court.		☐	☐	☐
2. Nia wants something calm to study to before the math test.		☐	☐	☐
3. Tomás wants a song in Spanish for his abuela's (grandma's) birthday dinner.		☐	☐	☐
4. Keisha wants a slow song for the last dance at the 8th-grade dance. (Swap jobs first!)		☐	☐	☐
5. Malik wants a first song for his party — one that makes everyone jump at once.		☐	☐	☐
6. Jordan wants a quiet guitar song for the talent-show sing-along.		☐	☐	☐
7. Ask the pair next to you for ONE request. Write it:		☐	☐	☐

THE TRAINING DATA LESSON • LESSON 2 OF 6

What's in the Playlist?



How AI learns — and where bias comes from. An AI is a music app, its training data is the playlist, and a one-vibe playlist (all loud, all fast, all party) means one-vibe answers. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Playlist Check worksheet, 2 pages, 1 per student — each fills their OWN sheet (typeable PDF copy included) · Slides (optional; script in the notes) · board · scissors optional	None — runs fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the deck	Print worksheets. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

- Explain how an AI learns: **input** → **patterns** → **output** — prediction from data, not magic. (Exit Ticket #1)
- Name who a dataset serves well and who it leaves out; link that gap to real AI bias. (Gap Report; Exit #2)
- Discuss data gaps collaboratively: repeat a partner's idea, then add to it. (Repeat, Then Add; Exit Ticket #3)

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

CSTA 2-IC-21

ISTE 1.1.d

CCSS ELA SL.6.1

Full text: Teacher Guide, p.3

DIFFERENTIATION

- Support:** Grey sentence starters on the worksheet; landmark-card tip in the Teacher Guide, p.2.
- Extension:** Design a 12-card playlist that serves every request on the sheet, then defend the trade-offs.
- ELL:** Fit marks are checked boxes, not sentences; invented cards may be in any language (that fixes a real gap).
- No-device classrooms:** Built in — the lesson is paper, pairs, and one loud imaginary music app.

WARM-UP — THE ONE-PLAYLIST APP (7 MIN)

You are **AutoMix**, the school's new music app. Your playlist holds one kind of song: loud, fast party tracks. Take 3–4 requests and serve every one with total confidence:

"Something chill to study to?" → "Here's 'TURBO TURBO.' It is not chill. It's what I've got."

"A song for grandma's birthday dinner?" → "Got it. 'VOLUME WAR.' Grandma loves bass drops, probably."

"A slow song for the last dance?" → "'NEON STAMPEDE,' played at... the exact same speed."

Then ask: **"Is AutoMix bad at picking songs — or is something else broken?"** Fish for it: the app is doing its job perfectly. The *playlist* is the problem.

If nobody gets there: "Could AutoMix play a slow song if it had one?" Yes — the app works. So what's missing?

Bridge: "(If your class did the genie lesson: it granted what you SAID.) Today: where an AI's answers even come from. Everything an AI 'knows' comes from a playlist of examples — its training data. It can remix the playlist, but it can't serve what was never in it. Today you'll BE the app."

Transition: "So what IS in an AI's playlist, and what does it do with it? Three words on the board."

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

"Did someone do this on purpose?" → Usually not. Teams collect the data that's easiest to get, and easy data leans toward whoever is already common. No villain required — which is why good AI teams audit their playlists before shipping.

A pair argues about a Fit box → each checks their own box on their own sheet. Disagreement is data — bring it to the debrief: "Two honest raters, two answers. What does that tell you about the playlist?"

A pair writes "it needs more songs" → ask WHO asked for something that wasn't there. The standard (2-IC-21) is about people, not song counts.

Every new card is a slow song → "Which request still has nothing? Tomás?" Push for a different gap per card. If asked **"isn't AI creative?"** → it can mash up playlist patterns into new combos, but not a genre it has never heard.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CSTA 2-IC-21** — Discuss issues of bias and accessibility in the design of existing technologies. *Taught: Playlist Check gap-mapping + Real Playlists debrief. Assessed: Gap Report Q2 + Exit Ticket #2.*
- **ISTE 1.1.d** — Students understand the fundamental concepts of technology operations, demonstrate the ability to choose, use and troubleshoot current technologies and are able to transfer their knowledge to explore emerging technologies. *Taught: No Magic in the Machine (input → patterns → output). Assessed: Exit Ticket #1; transfer to a new tool in Exit Ticket #2.*
- **CCSS ELA SL.6.1** — Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions (one-on-one, in groups, and teacher-led) with diverse partners on grade 6 topics, texts, and issues, building on others' ideas and expressing their own clearly. *Taught: the repeat-then-add rule in Playlist Check step 3. Assessed: "Repeat, Then Add" + Exit Ticket #3.*

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